

INTERVIEW TIPS

DOS

- **Prepare:** practice possible questions & research the company.
- **Make a good first impression:** look professional & be excited about the position.
- **Provide detailed responses** with specific examples/situations related to the job.
- **Sell yourself!** Showcase your skills, strengths & experiences that relate to the job.
- **Be engaging & confident:** use eye contact & be positive.
- **Always ask the interviewer questions at the end.** It shows you're interested & you did your homework.
- **Understand the next steps.** Always ask these questions at the end of an interview:
 - "When can I expect to hear back from you?"
 - "What are the next steps in the process?"
 - Don't ask this if they've already told you though...



DON'TS

- **Never ask about salary and/or benefits**, but be prepared to discuss it if they ask you what your salary requirements are.
- Do not bring up **negative situations** or talk bad about past employers.
- Avoid **rambling, mumbling**, and using **ums/ahs/likes**.
- **Minimize your nerves:** avoid fidgeting, swaying, sweating, tapping your feet, etc.
- **Avoid talking too much or too little:** answer the questions thoroughly, but don't go on forever...
- **Never be late and avoid being too early** (manage your time effectively and follow the directions/schedule provided).

★ THE STAR METHOD ★

What does *STAR* stand for? ???

Situation: describe the event or situation.

Task: explain the task you had to complete.

Action: describe the specific actions you had to take to complete the task.

Result: close by sharing the result of your efforts.

When do you use *STAR*?

S.T.A.R.

- STAR is used as a response technique during interviews.
- The STAR method is used when answering behavioral-based interview questions ("Tell me about a time when.." / "Have you ever...").

Why should you use *STAR*?



- This method is preferred by recruiters/interviewers when answering behavioral-based questions.
- STAR can help provide detailed responses and prove you have the experience & skills for the job.

How should you use *STAR*?



EXAMPLE | Behavioral Based Interview Q & A

QUESTION: "Tell me about a time when you had to complete a task/project with a group?"

RESPONSE: "Of course, I've had several situations where I've worked within a group, especially during my time throughout college..."

Situation- "One specific example is a group project from my xyz course at ISU..."

Task- "I worked with a team of 5 on a semester long research project that analyzed..."

Action- "I specifically compiled the data and composed the initial draft of the paper..."

Result- "As a result of our strong teamwork, organization and research, our team was able to create a valuable resource that identified... We also received an A on the project along with positive feedback from our professor."